

Curriculum Vitae – Yican Liu

Ph.D. Candidate in Finance

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Committee Members

Professor Fangzhou Lu (<i>Co-Chair</i>)	Professor Yiming Cao (<i>Co-Chair</i>)	Professor Mingzhu Tai
HKU Business School	HKU Business School	HKU Business School
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Education

2022-	University of Hong Kong <i>Ph.D., Finance</i>
2020-2022	Duke University <i>M.A., Economics, with Honor</i>
2015-2019	Renmin University of China <i>B.A., Finance</i>

Research

Research Interests

Financial technology; Development economics; Political economy

Under Revision

2026	How Valuable are Consumers' Digital Footprints? <i>Tingyu Feng, Yican Liu, Fangzhou Lu</i> <i>Revise and Resubmit</i> , Journal of Finance and Quantitative Analysis <i>Presented at</i> Tsinghua PBC School of Finance*, HKU Finance
2025	AI Exposure and Policy Preferences: Experimental Evidence from Latin America <i>Yiming Cao, Tian Chen, Yican Liu, Guillermo Rosas</i> <i>Conditionally Accepted via Pre-Results Review</i> , Journal of Development Economics <i>Additional Experiment in Progress (Planned Resubmission Date: 2027)</i> <i>Presented at</i> HKU Economics; HKU Finance; the Experimentation Webinar of Innovation Growth Lab*; the Political Data Science Lab at Washington University in St Louis*; Fudan University; American Political Science Association Annual Conference (Chicago)*; Princeton Politics*

Working Papers

- 2026 Crypto ATMs: Material Effects of Virtual Currencies
Lin William Cong, Tingyu Feng, Yican Liu, Fangzhou Lu
Presented at AFA 2027 (Scheduled), HKU Development Economics; HKU Finance; CES China 2026; NYU*; MIT*; Arizona State*; Dishui Lake Annual Conference (Shanghai University of Finance and Economics); Shanghai Advanced Institute of Finance; Renmin University of China; Jinan-Lingnan Joint Conference on Sustainable Finance*
- 2026 Happy App Happy Tip: The Return Predictability from Amusement Apps Downloads Around the World
Tse-Chun Lin, Yican Liu, Fangzhou Lu
Presented at Renmin University of China; HKU Finance; Waseda University; National Taiwan University*; Shenzhen University; New York University**

*Note: * for co-author presentation.*

Works in Progress

- 2026 The Politics of Cross-Sectional Stock Return of A-Shares, *joint with Fangzhou Lu and Hanyu Zheng*
 2025 Scientific Innovation in the Media, *joint with Yiming Cao, Tian Chen, and Guillermo Rosas*
 2025 AI Usage among Left-Behind Adolescents in China, *joint with Junyou Chen and Jingyuan Hu*
 2022 Economic Consequences of Conflicts, *joint with Tian Chen, Pei Gao, and Yu-Hsiang Lei*

Grants for Academic Research

- 2024-2025 OpenAI Researcher Access Program, *OpenAI*
 10,000 USD, *joint with Yiming Cao, Tian Chen, Guillermo Rosas*
- 2023-2026 Graduate Student Grant for Business Research, *HKU Business School, University of Hong Kong*
 45,000 HKD

Awards, Fellowships, and Honors

- 2022-2026 HKU Presidential Ph.D. Scholarship, *University of Hong Kong*
 2022-2025 Hong Kong Ph.D. Fellowship Scheme, *Research Grants Council of Hong Kong*
 2022 Ph.D. Student Entrance Scholarship, *HKU Business School, University of Hong Kong*
 2022 Award for Academic Excellence for Graduate Students, *Department of Economics, Duke University*
 2020, 2021 M.A. Merit Scholar Award, *Department of Economics, Duke University*
 2016, 2017 Merit Student of Renmin University of China, *School of Finance, Renmin University of China*

Professional Experiences

Presentation

2026

- Renmin University of China (School of Finance); HKU Finance Brownbag; CES China Annual Conference; Shanghai University of Finance and Economics (Dishui Lake Annual Conference)
- 2025 HKU Finance Brownbag; HKU Economics (Development Seminar); Lingnan-Jinan Joint Conference on Sustainable Finance; Renmin University of China (Renmin Business School)
- 2023 HKU Finance Brownbag; HKU Economics

Conference and Seminar Organization

- 2026 CES China Annual Conference, chair for session “Government Intervention and Market Outcomes” (at South Western University of Finance and Economics)
- 2026 The Economics of Technological Change, organizing committee, joint with Timm Betz, Yiming Cao, Tian Chen, and Guillermo Rosas (scheduled, at Washington University in St. Louis and Rice University)

Research Group Organization

- 2024-2027 Applied econometrics study group, University of Hong Kong
- 2023-2026 FinTech and behavioral economics research group, University of Hong Kong
- 2023-2026 South China village gazetteer program, with Tian Chen, Pei Gao, and Yu-Hsiang Lei, Washington University in St. Louis, National University of Singapore, Hong Kong University of Science and Technology, and University of Hong Kong
- 2018-2019 Empirical asset pricing study group, Renmin University of China

Surveys and Experiments

- 2025- (Field experiment) The AI therapist (Hong Kong SAR, China Mainland), with Junyou Chen and Jingyuan Hu, University of Hong Kong and University of California Irvine
- 2024- (Field experiment) AI adoption and its impact (Argentina, Brazil, Chile, Colombia, and Mexico), with Tian Chen, Yiming Cao, and Guillermo Rosas, University of Hong Kong, Rice University, and Washington University in St. Louis